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compact1, compact2, compact3

java.lang.annotation

Enum RetentionPolicy

java.lang.Object
    java.lang.Enum<RetentionPolicy>
        java.lang.annotation.RetentionPolicy

All Implemented Interfaces:

Serializable, Comparable<RetentionPolicy>

```
public enum RetentionPolicy
extends Enum<RetentionPolicy>
```

Annotation retention policy. The constants of this enumerated type describe the various policies for retaining annotations. They are used in conjunction with the Retention meta-annotation type to specify how long annotations are to be retained.

Since:

1.5

Enum Constant Summary

Enum Constants

Enum Constant	Description
CLASS	Annotations are to be recorded in the class file by the compiler but need not be retained by the VM at run time.
RUNTIME	Annotations are to be recorded in the class file by the compiler and retained by the VM at run time, so they may be read reflectively.

SOURCE	Annotations are to be discarded by the compiler.

Method Summary

Concrete Methods

Modifier and Type	Method	Description
static **RetentionPolicy**	**valueOf**(**String** name)	Returns the enum constant of this type with the specified name.
static **RetentionPolicy**[]	**values**()	Returns an array containing the constants of this enum type, in the order they are declared.

Methods inherited from class java.lang.Enum

clone, compareTo, equals, finalize, getDeclaringClass, hashCode, name, ordinal, toString, valueOf

Methods inherited from class java.lang.Object

getClass, notify, notifyAll, wait, wait, wait

Enum Constant Detail

SOURCE

```
public static final RetentionPolicy SOURCE
```

Annotations are to be discarded by the compiler.

CLASS

```
public static final RetentionPolicy CLASS
```

Annotations are to be recorded in the class file by the compiler but need not be retained by the VM at run time. This is the default behavior.

RUNTIME

```
public static final RetentionPolicy RUNTIME
```

Annotations are to be recorded in the class file by the compiler and retained by the VM at run time, so they may be read reflectively.

See Also:

AnnotatedElement

Method Detail

values

```
public static RetentionPolicy[] values()
```

Returns an array containing the constants of this enum type, in the order they are declared. This method may be used to iterate over the constants as follows:

```
for (RetentionPolicy c : RetentionPolicy.values())
    System.out.println(c);
```

Returns:

an array containing the constants of this enum type, in the order they are declared

valueOf

```
public static RetentionPolicy valueOf(String name)
```

Returns the enum constant of this type with the specified name. The string must match *exactly* an identifier used to declare an enum constant in this type. (Extraneous whitespace characters are not permitted.)

Parameters:

name - the name of the enum constant to be returned.

Returns:

the enum constant with the specified name

Throws:

IllegalArgumentException - if this enum type has no constant with the specified name

`NullPointerException` - if the argument is null

Submit a bug or feature
For further API reference and developer documentation, see Java SE Documentation. That documentation contains more detailed, developer-targeted descriptions, with conceptual overviews, definitions of terms, workarounds, and working code examples.
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